

STAGE THREE • JOB APPLICATION & INTERVIEW SKILLS

FIRSTS

PARTICIPANT PRE-WORK

A short primer to send before each session, so people arrive oriented

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Participant Pre-Work Handout

Stage Three • Job Application & Interview Skills

FOR FACILITATORS

Send the relevant section below 2-3 days before each session. This stage works best with real materials — real listings, real resumes, real deadlines — so encourage participants to bring their actual situation rather than a hypothetical one wherever possible.

Before Session 1: Building the Application

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- Bring your current resume and, if you have one, a cover letter you've used before.
- Identify 2–3 real job or internship listings you're genuinely interested in — we'll use real listings throughout this session, not hypothetical ones.

WHY THIS MATTERS

This session is about building real, usable materials against real opportunities. Arriving with actual listings means the work produced today is something you can genuinely act on afterward.

Before Session 2: Interview Readiness

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- Bring the STAR stories and behavioral answers you prepared in Session 1 — we'll be testing and performing them today, not writing new ones from scratch.
- If you know your target field involves a specific technical or case-style interview, come ready to mention that so practice can be somewhat tailored.

WHY THIS MATTERS

This is our most performance-heavy session. Coming prepared with existing material means session time goes to practicing under real conditions, not drafting from zero.

Before Session 3: Closing the Loop

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- If you have a real, current job search underway, bring your actual list of upcoming deadlines and any pending offers or interview follow-ups.
- No preparation needed if you don't currently have an active search — we'll work with a realistic hypothetical scenario instead.

WHY THIS MATTERS

This closing session works best against real, current stakes where possible. For anyone not yet actively searching, a realistic scenario still builds the same habits for when a real search begins.